of Sterling Corporation to 1.92 per cent, putting Pallonji in control of an aggregate of 5.96 per cent of the holding company.

In the same year, the company F.E. Dinshaw Ltd (Shapoorji Mistry, Cyrus Mistry's grandfather, became a shareholder of the company in 1928 and purchased it over time. Its name was changed to Cyrus Investments after the birth of Cyrus Mistry in 1968) acquired forty preference shares, again from Rodabeh. Thus, from the middle of the 1960s, Pallonji accumulated shares of Tata Sons whenever he chanced upon any. This caused severe consternation in the Tata family.

JRD was particularly incensed. He is reported to have said that the purchase of shares from JRD's siblings was an 'intrusion' of the Shapoorji Pallonji Group into Tata Sons by taking advantage of people who were 'weak-willed and credulous'. J.J. Irani commented that JRD was enraged over the manner in which Pallonji accumulated the shares. But Pallonji continued to do so, and another opportunity presented itself to him before long.

In the 1960s, the Sir Ratan Tata Trust substantially expanded its charity works and before the close of the decade, it found its coffers almost empty. Most of the wealth that came from dividends from the shares of Tata Sons proved inadequate to finance its ambitious programmes. To bail itself out, the trust put up 900 shares for sale in 1969. Pallonji bought them through Sterling Investment Corporation, raising his total holdings in Tata Sons to 10.77 per cent. At the time of the sale, Naval Tata was the chairman of the Sir Ratan Tata Trust. Ratan recalls that his father and Pallonji were close friends.

Five years later, in May 1974, the same corporation bought 910 ordinary shares in two caches of 290 and 620 shares from Darab Tata. It took the total holdings of Pallonji and his companies to 14.02 per cent. At the same time, Cyrus Investments also bought 965 ordinary shares or 3.44 per cent of the shares of TSL. The investment arm also bought forty-two preference shares. Thus, by the end of 1975, Pallonji and his companies had bought a total of 3,649 ordinary shares from the siblings of JRD and the Sir Ratan Tata Trust.

Another opportunity presented itself when the cash-strapped Tata Sons approved the rights issue in 1995 to raise funds to increase its stakes in its companies. As the ownership in some of the large companies was